



FOCUS ON...

SILVER

Silver is the most common precious metal and has a wide range of uses.



▲ Thin, edible silver foil is used to decorate sweets.



▲ Silver nitrate mixed with water is used as a gentle antiseptic for cuts and scrapes.



▲ Silver is commonly used in jewellery such as necklaces, bangles, and rings.

Silver

47
Ag

Like the precious metals gold, platinum, and palladium, silver is found pure in nature. It stays shiny for a while, but unlike other precious metals, silver reacts slowly with traces of sulfur in the air to create a black tarnish.

ATOMIC MASS 107.868

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY Around 3000 BCE

This silver was left behind when hot, mineral-rich water trickled through rocks.

**Twists of silver
on quartz**

